made into jelly. Aerated and non-aerated fruit juice is a popular soft drink.

Banana

Botanical name : *Musa* x *paradisiaca*
Family: Musaceae

Origin and Area of cultivation


Figure 10.6: Banana

Bananas were domesticated in South East Asia. Tamil Nadu is the world's No. 1 banana producer. Theni, Trichy, Erode, Thoothukudi, Coimbatore, Kanyakumari, Thanjavur and Dindigul are the prominent regions in Tamil Nadu where the crop is being cultivated. Major cultivars of banana are Chevazhai, Nentheran, Karpooravalli, Poovan and Peyan.

Uses

The banana fruit is loaded with potassium and essential vitamins, which can be eaten raw or cooked (deep fried, dehydrated, baked or steamed). The fruit can be processed into flour and can be fermented for the production of beverages such as banana juice, beer, vinegar and vine.

Jack fruit (State fruit of Tamil Nadu)

Botanical name : *Artocarpus heterophyllus*
Family: Moraceae

Origin and Area of cultivation

The jackfruit has originated in the Western Ghats of India and it is the state fruit of Tamil Nadu. The major Jack fruit cultivating areas of Tamil Nadu are Cuddalore, Kanyakumari, Dindigul, Pudukottai, Namakkal, Tirunelveli and Nilgiris. Panruti and Coimbatore districts are the major marketing centres.


Figure 10.7: Jackfruit

Uses

The fruit can be eaten raw or cooked. Unripe flake slices are deep-fried to make crispy chips. The seeds are either boiled or roasted and eaten. Unripe fruits are used as vegetables.

10.1.7 Nuts

Nuts are simple dry fruits composed of a hard shell and an edible kernel. They are packed with a good source of healthy fats, fibre, protein, vitamins, minerals and antioxidants. Some of the important nuts are discussed below.

Cashew nut

Botanical name : *Anacardium occidentale*
Family: Anacardiaceae

Origin and Area of cultivation

Cashew has originated in Brazil and made its way to India in the 16th century through Portuguese sailors. Cashew is grown in Kerala, Karnataka, Goa, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, and Orissa.

Uses

Cashews are commonly used for garnishing sweets or curries, or ground into a paste that forms a base of sauces for curries or some sweets. Roasted and raw kernels are used as snacks.

Table 10.1 : Other common fruits

S.No	Common Name	Tamil Name	Botanical name	Family	Edible part
1	Guava	கொய்யா	*Psidium guajava*	Myrtaceae	Mesocarp and Endocarp
2	Papaya	பப்பாளி	*Carica papaya*	Caricaceae	Mesocarp
3	Pomegranate	மாதுளை	*Punica granatum*	Punicaceae	Aril
4	Fig	அத்தி	*Ficus carica*	Moraceae	Fleshy receptacle
5	Date Palm	பேரீச்சம்	*Phoenix dactylifera*	Arecaceae	Pericarp

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